

Study Report: OWASP Top Ten - Cybersecurity Analyst

Written by Gagan Pasupuleti

Family: Cybersecurity Analyst
Level: Beginner
Chapters: 7
Source: Reference: OWASP Top Ten - OWASP Foundation

Official sources and free libraries

- <https://owasp.org/www-project-top-ten/>

Summary

Study report for *OWASP Top Ten* by OWASP Foundation (Beginner level) mapped to the Cybersecurity Analyst role. Free guide to the ten most critical web application risks (2021).

Chapters

Track: Book-Intro

Chapter 1: About OWASP Top Ten [Beginner]

Chapter focus: About OWASP Top Ten** *(Level: Beginner)

This study report summarizes *OWASP Top Ten* by OWASP Foundation for the Cybersecurity Analyst role. The resource is rated Beginner level. Free guide to the ten most critical web application risks (2021). Use this report alongside the official material to prepare for CodeQuest review.

Code Reference:

```
# OWASP Top Ten
# Author: OWASP Foundation
# Role: Cybersecurity Analyst
# Level: Beginner
```

What it shows: Metadata block records the source book and target role family.

Topic guide

What it actually is

A structured study report based on OWASP Top Ten.

When to use it

When learning Cybersecurity Analyst skills at Beginner level.

Where to use it

Cybersecurity Analyst training paths and certification prep.

Real use example

A learner reads this report before starting the full book or free online guide.

Track: Book-Context

Chapter 2: Why This Book Matters for Your Role [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Why This Book Matters for Your Role *(Level: Beginner)**

Cybersecurity Analyst professionals use ideas from OWASP Top Ten to solve real workplace problems. Free guide to the ten most critical web application risks (2021). This chapter explains how the book fits into your learning path and what you should be able to do after studying it.

Code Reference:

Role: Cybersecurity Analyst

Book focus: Free guide to the ten most critical web application risks (2021).

Recommended level: Beginner

What it shows: Connects the book topic to the job role outcomes.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Role-aligned learning connects theory to job tasks.

When to use it

During career planning and syllabus design.

Where to use it

Cybersecurity Analyst bootcamps and CodeQuest teacher assignments.

Real use example

A teacher assigns this book report before a beginner skills checkpoint.

Track: Book-Topics

Chapter 3: Key Topics Covered [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Key Topics Covered *(Level: Beginner)**

The main topics in OWASP Top Ten include practical concepts described as: Free guide to the ten most critical web application risks (2021). Study each topic with hands-on practice. Take notes on definitions, workflows, and examples that match tools used in Cybersecurity Analyst jobs today.

Code Reference:

- Topic 1: core concept
- Topic 2: core concept
- Topic 3: core concept
- Topic 4: core concept

What it shows: Topic list guides what to study chapter-by-chapter in the source.

Topic guide**What it actually is**

Topic maps turn a book into actionable learning objectives.

When to use it

Before reading and while building chapter summaries.

Where to use it

Self-study, flipped classroom, and revision.

Real use example

A student maps each book chapter to a CodeQuest report section.

Track: Book-Applied

Chapter 4: Applied: Security Analyst Role and Defense in Depth [Beginner]**Chapter focus: Security Analyst Role and Defense in Depth** *(Level: Beginner)**

Security analysts protect confidentiality, integrity, and availability. Defense in depth layers controls: policies, network segmentation, identity, endpoint, application, and monitoring. Blue team focuses on detect-and-respond; understand red team findings without becoming adversarial. Document everything-incidents become legal evidence.

Code Reference:

```
layers = ['Policy', 'Perimeter', 'Network', 'Host', 'App', 'Data', 'Monitoring']
```

What it shows: Layer model explains where controls belong in architecture reviews.

Topic guide**What it actually is**

Cybersecurity analysts detect threats and reduce organizational risk.

When to use it

Continuous monitoring of enterprise IT and cloud estates.

Where to use it

SOCs, MSSPs, internal security teams, and compliance-heavy orgs.

Real use example

CodeQuest SOC analyst spots unusual API traffic pattern during nightly log review.

Chapter 5: Applied: OWASP Top 10 2021 Overview [Beginner]

Chapter focus: OWASP Top 10 2021 Overview *(Level: Beginner)**

OWASP Top 10 lists critical web risks: Broken Access Control, Cryptographic Failures, Injection, Insecure Design, Security Misconfiguration, Vulnerable Components, Auth Failures, Integrity Failures, Logging Failures, and SSRF. Developers and analysts share this vocabulary for prioritization.

Code Reference:

```
owasp_2021 = ['A01 Broken Access Control', 'A02 Crypto Failures', 'A03 Injection',  
             'A04 Insecure Design', 'A05 Misconfiguration']
```

What it shows: Enumerating categories structures appsec assessment checklists.

Topic guide**What it actually is**

OWASP Top 10 is the industry standard web application risk list.

When to use it

Web app pen tests, secure SDLC training, and bug bounty triage.

Where to use it

SaaS products, education portals, and e-commerce platforms.

Real use example

IDOR in quiz API lets student A view student B grades-A01 broken access control.

Chapter 6: Applied: CIA Triad and Authentication Basics [Beginner]

Chapter focus: CIA Triad and Authentication Basics *(Level: Beginner)**

Confidentiality (encryption, access control), Integrity (hashing, signing), Availability (redundancy, DDoS mitigation). Authentication proves identity; authorization grants permissions. MFA blocks most credential stuffing. Password policies alone are insufficient.

Code Reference:

```
import hashlib  
hashlib.sha256(b'password123').hexdigest() # never store plaintext
```

What it shows: Hashing demos why databases must not store raw passwords.

Topic guide

What it actually is

CIA triad frames every security control decision.

When to use it

Designing systems handling student PII and payment data.

Where to use it

Identity systems, databases, and API gateways.

Real use example

MFA rollout stops 99% of spray attempts against teacher admin portal.

Track: Book-Plan

Chapter 7: Study Plan and Practice [Beginner]

Chapter focus: Study Plan and Practice** *(Level: Beginner)

Finish OWASP Top Ten with a weekly plan: read one section, write a summary, complete one exercise, and reflect on how it applies to Cybersecurity Analyst. If a free edition exists, practice every example. Submit your notes and one mini-project demo for teacher review.

Code Reference:

Week 1: Read + notes
Week 2: Exercises
Week 3: Mini project
Week 4: Review + quiz

What it shows: A 4-week plan turns reading into demonstrable skill.

Topic guide

What it actually is

Structured study plans improve retention and portfolio outcomes.

When to use it

After finishing the key topics chapters.

Where to use it

CodeQuest end-of-unit assessments.

Real use example

A learner completes the study plan and uploads a beginner project screenshot.